

FCE I · UNIT 2 · GRAMMAR P21**Revision: past tenses, used to and would**

About 15 minutes. Do it in pencil, then check with your teacher.

Past simple: finished events, one after another. **Past continuous:** an action in progress, background, or interrupted by a past simple event.

used to: past habits and states (no longer true). **would:** past habits only, never states (be, have, like).

1 Circle the correct option.

1. While Nuria (crossed / was crossing) the Plaza del Ayuntamiento, a firework went off.
2. Jordi (opened / was opening) the door, walked in and sat down.
3. I (watched / was watching) the mascletà when my phone rang.
4. When we were children, we (used to go / were going) to the Malvarrosa every Sunday.
5. My grandmother (would be / used to be) very shy when she was young.
6. Every summer, Paula (would swim / was swimming) in the sea before breakfast.
7. While Sergio (cooked / was cooking) the paella, the guests arrived.
8. Pablo (didn't use to / didn't used to) like horchata.

2 Complete with the past simple or past continuous of the verb.

1. The lights _____ (go out) while we _____ (watch) the fireworks in Las Arenas.
2. Irene _____ (take) a photo and then _____ (post) it online.
3. What _____ you _____ (do) at eight o'clock last night?
4. Daniel _____ (not / hear) the alarm because he _____ (sleep).
5. Rubén _____ (walk) along the beach when he _____ (see) a dolphin.
6. Clara _____ (not / go) out because it _____ (rain).

3 Write U (used to), W (would) or B (both are possible).

1. Every August, my family _____ rent a flat in Cullera.
2. There _____ be a cinema on our street, but it closed.
3. When I was a child, I _____ have a pet rabbit.
4. On Saturdays, Nuria _____ get up early and walk along the Turia.
5. Gemma _____ be afraid of fireworks when she was little.

4 Find and correct the mistake. Rewrite the sentence.

1. I didn't used to like olives.

2. Yesterday evening I was going to the cinema with Carlos.

3. When I was small, I would be very shy.

4. Jordi was breaking his arm while he was playing football.

5 Your turn. Write two true sentences.

1. Something you used to do when you were ten, but don't do now.

2. What you were doing at eight o'clock yesterday evening.
